SANATANVERSE

MASTER BRAND BLUEPRINT
AND OPERATING PLAYBOOK

An editable, step-by-step guide to building a global Sanatan Dharma knowledge, storytelling and entertainment brand.

DOCUMENT VERSION	1.0
DATE	26 October 2026
STATUS	Foundation and planning
WORKING BRAND NAME	SanatanVerse — subject to availability checks
INITIAL BUDGET	Rs. 5,000–Rs. 15,000
CORE PROJECT	The Sanatan Timeline — interactive chronology and knowledge experience

RESEARCH CAREFULLY • ATTRIBUTE HONESTLY • CREATE BEAUTIFULLY • TEST RIGOROUSLY

Use the interactive checkboxes in a PDF reader that supports PDF forms. Save a copy to preserve completed items.

How to use this playbook

This is the working checklist for the whole brand. Complete tasks in order where dependencies matter. Checkboxes are interactive PDF form fields; save the file after updating it. Keep a master copy and create dated versions before major revisions.

Document control

- Assign a version owner and review date.
- Keep the latest approved copy in the project folder.
- Record major decisions in the decision log.
- Review open tasks weekly and update completion status.

Status conventions

Priority	Meaning
P0	Required for a trustworthy launch.
P1	Important for usability or content quality.
P2	Useful after validation.
P3	Future expansion.

1. Executive Summary

Vision

Build a global Sanatan Dharma knowledge, storytelling and entertainment brand that makes Hindu traditions, sacred stories, philosophy, cultural heritage and related history accessible through modern media and technology.

Mission

Preserve, explain and creatively communicate the richness and diversity of Sanatan Dharma through trustworthy research, beautiful storytelling and accessible technology.

Founding principles

- Respect Hindu traditions and their diversity.
- Distinguish sacred chronology from independently established historical and scientific chronology.
- Clearly label creative adaptations and fictional additions.
- Attribute claims to reliable sources.
- Respect intellectual property, translation rights and cultural sensitivities.
- Build quality and audience trust before pursuing scale.
- Make products accessible to audiences in India and abroad.
- Reinvest validated revenue into better research, content and technology.

2. Brand Architecture

Parent brand

Working name: SanatanVerse. Proposed tagline: Ancient Wisdom. Timeless Stories. The name remains provisional until availability and legal risks have been checked.

Division	Purpose	Priority
SanatanVerse Timeline	Interactive sacred, historical and scientific chronology	P0
SanatanVerse Stories	Illustrated stories, comics and books	P1
SanatanVerse Learn	Educational explanations and source guides	P1
SanatanVerse Studios	Animation, motion comics and films	P2
SanatanVerse World	Interactive experiences and digital products	P2
SanatanVerse Collectibles	Art prints, cards and merchandise	P3

Naming and identity

- Search exact and similar names in relevant trademark classes.
- Check domain availability.
- Check YouTube and major social-media handles.
- Review pronunciation and meaning in Indian and international contexts.
- Assess distinctiveness and legal defensibility.

- [ ] Create a simple logo, wordmark and favicon.
- [ ] Establish typography, color palette and illustration rules.
- [ ] Define rules for sacred symbols and religious imagery.
- [ ] Save approved brand assets and licence records.
- [ ] Document the final name decision and date.

3. Audience and Positioning

Primary audiences: children and families; young adults; adults and practitioners; international audiences; educators and researchers.

Positioning: SanatanVerse is a research-informed storytelling and learning brand exploring Sanatan Dharma and its cultural world through sacred narratives, historical research, scientific context and modern digital experiences.

Positioning controls

- [ ] Document the primary audience for the first product.
- [ ] Define the product's main user problem and value.
- [ ] Validate that the language is accessible to the target audience.
- [ ] Avoid unsupported claims such as first, largest or most authoritative.
- [ ] Document how the brand differs from alternatives.

4. Editorial and Research Constitution

Content categories

A. Traditional and sacred material: identify the text, tradition, commentary or lineage; cite specific passages; explain differing interpretations; do not automatically convert traditional dates into historical dates.

B. Historical and scientific material: cite credible research or primary evidence; state date ranges and uncertainty; distinguish event dates from text-composition dates.

C. Creative adaptations: label adaptations and fiction; document departures from source narratives; do not invent scriptural quotations; track creative rights.

Evidence label	Definition
Well established	Supported by strong, converging evidence.
Estimated date	Evidence supports a range, but the exact date is uncertain.
Traditional chronology	A date or sequence attributed to a specified tradition.
Textual evidence	A source is documented; the narrated event needs separate assessment.
Debated	Material disagreement or unresolved evidence exists.
Unverified claim	Insufficient evidence to present as established.

Source verification checklist

- [ ] Identify the precise claim being made.
- [ ] Find a source that directly supports it.

- [ ] Record author, title, publisher and publication date.
- [ ] Record page, chapter, verse, inscription or stable URL.
- [ ] Record the access date.
- [ ] Classify the source as primary or secondary.
- [ ] Check the source's qualifications and limitations.
- [ ] Look for contrary evidence and alternative interpretations.
- [ ] Verify quotations against the exact edition.
- [ ] Record reviewer and review status.
- [ ] Recheck time-sensitive claims before publication.

5. The Sanatan Timeline — Product Specification

Objective: an interactive digital timeline exploring cosmic origins through the present, connecting sacred, scientific and historical chronology.

Initial eras

1. Cosmic origins: Scientific cosmology and Hindu creation traditions.
2. Earth and life: Formation of Earth, evolution and human origins.
3. Early South Asian civilizations: Prehistory, Indus/Harappan civilization and archaeological uncertainty.
4. Vedic traditions: Vedic texts, oral transmission, ritual traditions and textual history.
5. Upanishads and philosophy: Brahman, atman, karma, rebirth, moksha and philosophical schools.
6. Itihasa and epic traditions: Ramayana, Mahabharata and Bhagavad Gita; traditional dates separated from textual history.
7. Classical religious and intellectual life: Puranic traditions, philosophy, temples and literature.
8. Bhakti and regional traditions: Devotional movements, pilgrimage, poetry and regional traditions.
9. Early modern India and modern Hindu identities: Regional developments, colonial transformations and reform.
10. Contemporary traditions: Independent India, diaspora, contemporary practice and digital religious life.

MVP features

- [ ] Chronological overview.
- [ ] Switchable sacred, scientific and historical tracks.
- [ ] Event detail pages.
- [ ] Date type, uncertainty and evidence labels.
- [ ] Source references and bibliography.
- [ ] Related people, texts, places and concepts.
- [ ] Search and filters.
- [ ] Correction and feedback mechanism.

Required event fields

- Unique event ID, title, summary and full explanation.
- Era, category and timeline track.
- Traditional date or range, where applicable.
- Historical date range, where supported.
- Text-composition date range, where relevant.
- Calendar system and date notation.
- Evidence label and uncertainty notes.
- Source references and related entities.
- Artwork and licensing details.
- Author, reviewer and review dates.
- Publication status and version history.

6. Research and Content Production Workflow

Stage 1 — Discovery

- Define the topic and audience value.
- Classify the topic as sacred, historical, scientific or creative.
- Record priority and likely sources.

Exit condition: A clearly scoped research task.

Stage 2 — Research

- Collect and read relevant sources.
- Record precise references.
- Extract supported claims and identify disagreements.
- Record permissions where necessary.

Exit condition: Evidence supports a responsible draft, or gaps are explicitly recorded.

Stage 3 — Claim review

- Break the draft into individual claims.
- Map each claim to sources and evidence type.
- Record counterevidence and caveats.
- Obtain review for material claims.

Exit condition: Every material claim is supported or properly qualified.

Stage 4 — Drafting

- [ ] Write headline, summary and explanation.
- [ ] Add timeline placement, evidence label and references.
- [ ] Add related entries and caveats.

Exit condition: Draft follows the editorial style guide.

Stage 5 — Visual production

- [ ] Create or source artwork.
- [ ] Check cultural and historical details.
- [ ] Verify rights and licences.
- [ ] Add captions and alt text.

Exit condition: Visuals are approved for the intended use.

Stage 6 — Editorial review

- [ ] Review accuracy, context and representation.
- [ ] Check terminology, translation and chronology.
- [ ] Resolve unsupported certainty and misleading visuals.

Exit condition: High-impact review issues are resolved.

Stage 7 — QA and publication

- [ ] Validate fields, dates and source links.
- [ ] Test search, navigation, accessibility and devices.
- [ ] Verify rights and record release version.

Exit condition: No release-blocking defects remain.

Stage 8 — Maintenance

- [ ] Track corrections and broken links.
- [ ] Revisit outdated or disputed claims.
- [ ] Record new evidence and version history.

Exit condition: Entry remains maintainable after publication.

7. Technology and Architecture

Component	Initial choice
Frontend	Next.js and TypeScript
Styling	Tailwind CSS
Data	Version-controlled JSON files
Search	Client-side search initially
Hosting	Suitable free tier, subject to current limits
Version control	GitHub
Automated tests	Playwright
Future database	SQLite or PostgreSQL when justified

Technical quality gates

- [ ] No broken internal links.
- [ ] No missing required event fields.
- [ ] No unsupported date conversions.
- [ ] No draft entries published accidentally.
- [ ] No unlicensed production assets.
- [ ] Responsive layout on mobile and desktop.
- [ ] Keyboard-accessible navigation and meaningful alt text.
- [ ] Basic performance and accessibility checks.
- [ ] Code and content version control.
- [ ] Backups of source library and project files.

Repository starter structure

docs/ — brand strategy, editorial policy, research standard, product requirements and release checklist.

content/ — eras, events, sources, people, texts, concepts and places.

public/ — images and fonts.

src/ — app, components, features, utilities and types.

tests/ — unit, integration and end-to-end tests.

scripts/ — validation and maintenance utilities.

8. Brand Product Roadmap

Phase 0 — Foundation

Brand identity, editorial constitution, source policy, timeline schema, product requirements and rights register.

- [ ] Complete and review Phase 0 — Foundation.

Phase 1 — Timeline MVP

10–15 researched entries, three tracks, era navigation, event details, citations, search and responsive layout.

- [ ] Complete and review Phase 1 — Timeline MVP.

Phase 2 — Research library

Expanded chronology, source catalogue, connected entries, review workflow and correction process.

- [ ] Complete and review Phase 2 — Research library.

Phase 3 — Illustrated stories

Character guide, short illustrated story, digital edition, reader feedback and print assessment.

- [ ] Complete and review Phase 3 — Illustrated stories.

Phase 4 — Distribution

YouTube and social content, explainers, illustrated entries and a repeatable publication schedule.

- [ ] Complete and review Phase 4 — Distribution.

Phase 5 — Commercial validation

Digital offer, print-on-demand trial, customer feedback and unit economics.

- [ ] Complete and review Phase 5 — Commercial validation.

Phase 6 — Expansion

Multilingual editions, animation, education products, collectibles, licensing and interactive learning.

- [ ] Complete and review Phase 6 — Expansion.

9. Intellectual Property and Legal Controls

Brand ownership

- [ ] Verify brand name and similar marks.
- [ ] Identify relevant trademark classes with professional guidance if needed.
- [ ] Maintain ownership and licence records.
- [ ] Document rights to characters, illustrations, scripts and logos.
- [ ] Plan for legal and accounting support as the business grows.

Content rights

- [ ] Record creator and source for every asset.
- [ ] Record licence and commercial-use permission.
- [ ] Record attribution and modification requirements.
- [ ] Record territory and duration where relevant.
- [ ] Save proof of purchase or written permission.

AI-assisted creation

- Record tools and assets used.
- Check commercial-use terms.
- Follow platform AI disclosure requirements.
- Review generated images for errors and unwanted similarities.
- Do not assume AI generation automatically establishes exclusive ownership.

Publishing and privacy

- Review consumer-protection requirements.
- Review payment and tax obligations.
- Establish appropriate privacy and data-handling practices.
- Obtain permission before collecting personal information.
- Apply safeguards appropriate to children.
- Check publisher and marketplace requirements at release.

10. Business Model

Potential revenue streams include digital illustrated books, print-on-demand books and comics, educational products, platform monetization, paid digital resources, merchandise, licensing, media rights and educational collaborations.

Commercial validation

- Validate that users find the content useful.
- Test willingness to pay for a specific product.
- Calculate actual production and distribution costs.
- Measure contribution per sale.
- Expand only when quality, demand and viability are demonstrated.

Financial tracking

- Track product development cost.
- Track research, review, artwork and licensing costs.
- Track printing, shipping, marketplace fees and marketing.
- Track sales, refunds and contribution per sale.
- Track cash available for reinvestment.

11. Marketing and Audience Development

Content pillar	Example coverage
Cosmic questions	Hindu cosmology and scientific perspectives, clearly distinguished.
Sacred stories	Narratives from identified textual and regional traditions.
Philosophy explained	Dharma, karma, atman, Brahman and moksha.
History and evidence	Archaeology, inscriptions, textual history and uncertainty.
Living traditions	Festivals, pilgrimage, practices, languages and communities.
Creative storytelling	Comics, character art, animation and adaptations.

Marketing controls

- Choose one or two manageable launch channels.
- Use the website as the authoritative knowledge hub.
- Cite sources for factual claims.
- Label fictional adaptations.
- Avoid manufactured controversy and misleading certainty.
- Obtain permissions for artwork and music.
- Measure engagement and customer interest, not only follower counts.

12. Solo-Founder Operating System

Work block	Main responsibility
Research	Select topics and verify sources.
Writing	Draft timeline entries and stories.
Production	Create illustrations and layouts.
Development	Improve the timeline product.
QA	Test content, sources, functionality and presentation.
Review	Assess feedback, finances and priorities.

Weekly operating rhythm

- Review the backlog and priorities.
- Identify blocked tasks and dependencies.
- Complete research and content work in manageable batches.
- Run quality checks before publication.
- Review spending and budget remaining.
- Record significant decisions and next actions.

Decision log template

Date	Decision	Reason/evidence	Alternatives	Review date
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

13. Quality Assurance Framework

Content testing

- Factual claims have sources.
- Source links resolve correctly.
- Textual and event dates are distinguished.
- Traditional chronology is attributed.
- Uncertainty is visible.
- Translations are checked.
- Creative additions are labelled.
- Cultural context is accurate.
- Corrections are traceable.

Functional testing

- Era navigation works.
- Timeline tracks can be filtered.
- Search returns appropriate results.
- Event details open correctly.
- Related-entry links work.
- Date ranges display correctly.
- Missing dates do not break the interface.
- Invalid content is rejected or flagged.
- Mobile and desktop layouts work.
- Keyboard navigation and accessibility are checked.

Release checklist

- Research review complete.
- Editorial review complete.

Artwork rights verified.

Content schema validated.

Automated tests pass.

Manual smoke tests pass.

No release-blocking defects remain.

Backups and version tags created.

Release notes prepared.

Feedback and correction channels available.

14. Metrics and Milestones

Timeframe	Milestones
First 30 days	Brand direction, editorial constitution, data schema, 10–15 researched entries and first interface prototype.
First 60 days	Responsive prototype, tested search/navigation/citations, audience feedback and resolved major issues.
First 90 days	Public beta, repeatable QA, expanded source library and a data-informed next-stage decision.

Ongoing metrics to track

Number of entries with verified references.

Percentage of entries passing review.

Unresolved high-priority corrections.

Broken-link rate.

Reader engagement with entries.

User-reported corrections.

Product conversion and repeat purchases.

Production cost per finished entry.

Time required to research and publish content.

15. Risk Register

Risk	Control
Unsupported historical claims	Claim-level citations and independent review.
Confusing sacred and historical chronology	Separate date fields and evidence labels.
Incorrect or fabricated references	Source verification and periodic audits.
Copyright infringement	Asset register and licence checks.
Inconsistent AI artwork	Character guides and human review.
Excessive scope	Phased roadmap and prioritization.
Low audience demand	Early feedback and small product tests.
Budget overruns	Spending limits and approval gates.
Outdated research	Review dates and version history.
Misrepresentation of traditions	Context, attribution and qualified review.
Technical failure	Automated tests, backups and release checks.
Privacy or child-safety issues	Data minimization and appropriate safeguards.

16. Immediate Action Plan

Foundation tasks — complete in order

- Confirm working brand name and complete availability checks.
- Approve mission, positioning and editorial constitution.
- Create the master timeline data schema.
- Establish source and rights registers.
- Select the first 10–15 timeline entries.
- Research and review those entries.
- Build the smallest usable timeline prototype.
- Test the interface and content.
- Obtain audience feedback.
- Choose the next product direction based on evidence.

Definition of foundation complete

The foundation is complete when the brand has a documented identity, clear editorial standards, a structured research system, a functioning prototype, verified sample content, a repeatable QA process and a realistic next-stage plan.

RESEARCH CAREFULLY. ATTRIBUTE HONESTLY. CREATE BEAUTIFULLY. TEST RIGOROUSLY. PUBLISH RESPONSIBLY. EXPAND ONLY WHEN READY.

Version history: v1.0 — initial master brand blueprint and editable checklist edition.